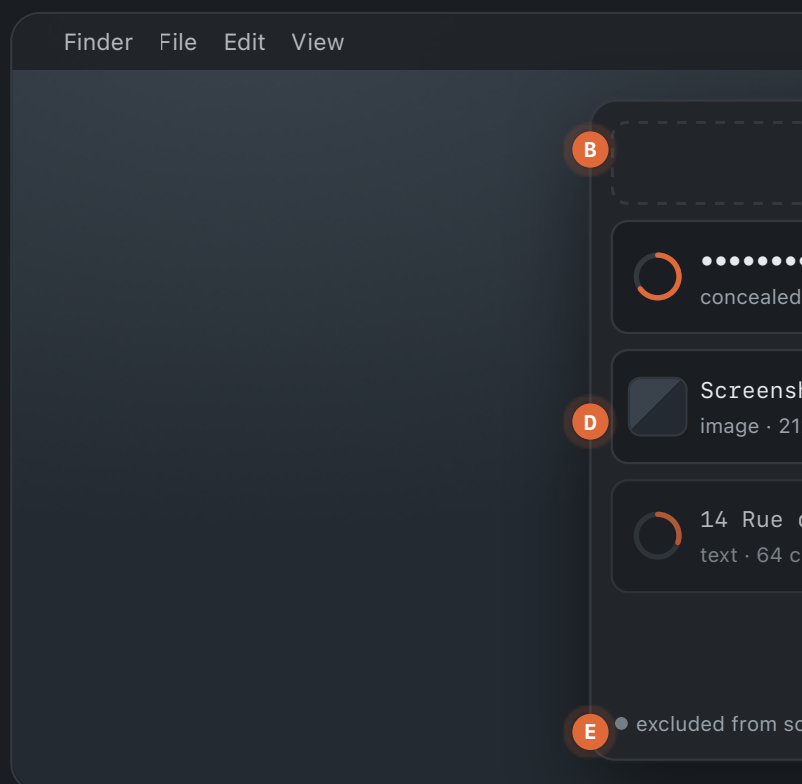


What “present, not centre stage” looks like

The brief argues it; this board shows it. A menu-bar icon, an edge-docked panel the width of a sidebar, and a small working set of SleeperCells — each wearing its time remaining as its most prominent attribute.

The stage

Everything the app ever occupies on screen. Letters on the mockup key to the annotations beside it.



A Menu bar icon.

Monochrome template glyph, no badge, no count. Click toggles the panel; drag-hover opens it to receive a drop. The app's only permanent presence.

B Drop zone.

Always present at the top; also the ⌘V target. Arrival creates a cell instantly — no dialog, no naming step. The cell appearing is the receipt.

C The SleeperCell.

Ring drains over the cell's life (watch the top one). Secret-shaped content arrives masked; the TTL label cycles on click; ↗ link is hover-revealed, always

present to assistive tech.

D Non-activating panel.

NSPanel semantics: opening it never steals focus from the user's work. Summoned by hotkey, icon, or a drag toward the edge; gone on Esc.

E Footer whisper.

Capture exclusion stated plainly, and nothing else — connection status appears here only if an account is configured.

One cell, five states

The lifecycle is the interface. Urgency shifts ring geometry — thickness and texture — not colour alone.



Staged

8h

Just arrived at the default TTL. Full ring, quiet presence.



Draining

3h 40m

Ambient and honest. Copy-out doesn't consume the cell — multi-paste is a core moment.



Last hour

43m

Stroke thickens and breaks — a second channel besides hue. Still no notification; the user set this clock.



Promoted

link copied

One-time link on the



Expired

—

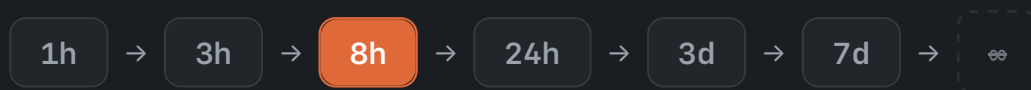
Silent removal, content

clipboard, receipt id kept on the cell. Offers **Burn local copy**, then resumes draining if kept.

zeroized. Drawn here only for the board — in the app there is nothing to show, by design.

The TTL ladder

Click any rung — or the label on a real cell — and the clock resets to that value. One affordance for extend, shorten, and reset.



The struck-out ∞ is the design statement: seven days is the ceiling, and the absence of “keep forever” is a feature, not a gap. Default is 8h — a working day (open question N^o1). VoiceOver reads the label as an adjustable value; arrows step the ladder.

Promotion, in three frames

The app's only network operation — unmistakably an action, never a side effect.

FRAME 1 · INTENT

postgres://ops:●●●●@db-3...

2h 10m

↗ link

Click ↗ link (or L). First run, this is the one place the app ever mentions accounts.

FRAME 2 · CONFIRM, INLINE

expires 2h — seeded from time left

domain secrets.example.com

passphrase optional

Create one-time link

No modal. TTL snaps to server-allowed values; the network boundary is visible before it's crossed.

FRAME 3 · PROMOTED

✓ Link copied

receipt 9f2...

POST /api/v3/secret/conceal · 201

Burn local copy

The content has a better home now — so the local cell offers to disappear early.

Visual aide to the [milestone-1 design brief](#); full spec lives at [docs/specs/macOS-companion](#). Set in the platform's voice (SF Pro, SF Mono, New York via system stacks); the ember is Onetime Secret's #d45a2a, spent only on time and action. The hero cell's ring drains for real — 75 seconds standing in for 8 hours — and holds still under reduced motion.